USER HANDBOOK / FINAL GUI RELEASE

DUPLICATE PAIR CLEANER

Keep the right copy.

Keep its matching companion.

Review changes before they happen.

REAL WINDOWS DESKTOP APP

Folder browser / Grouped previews / Safe backups

VERSION 3.0.0 · OCTOBER 2026 · MIT LICENSE

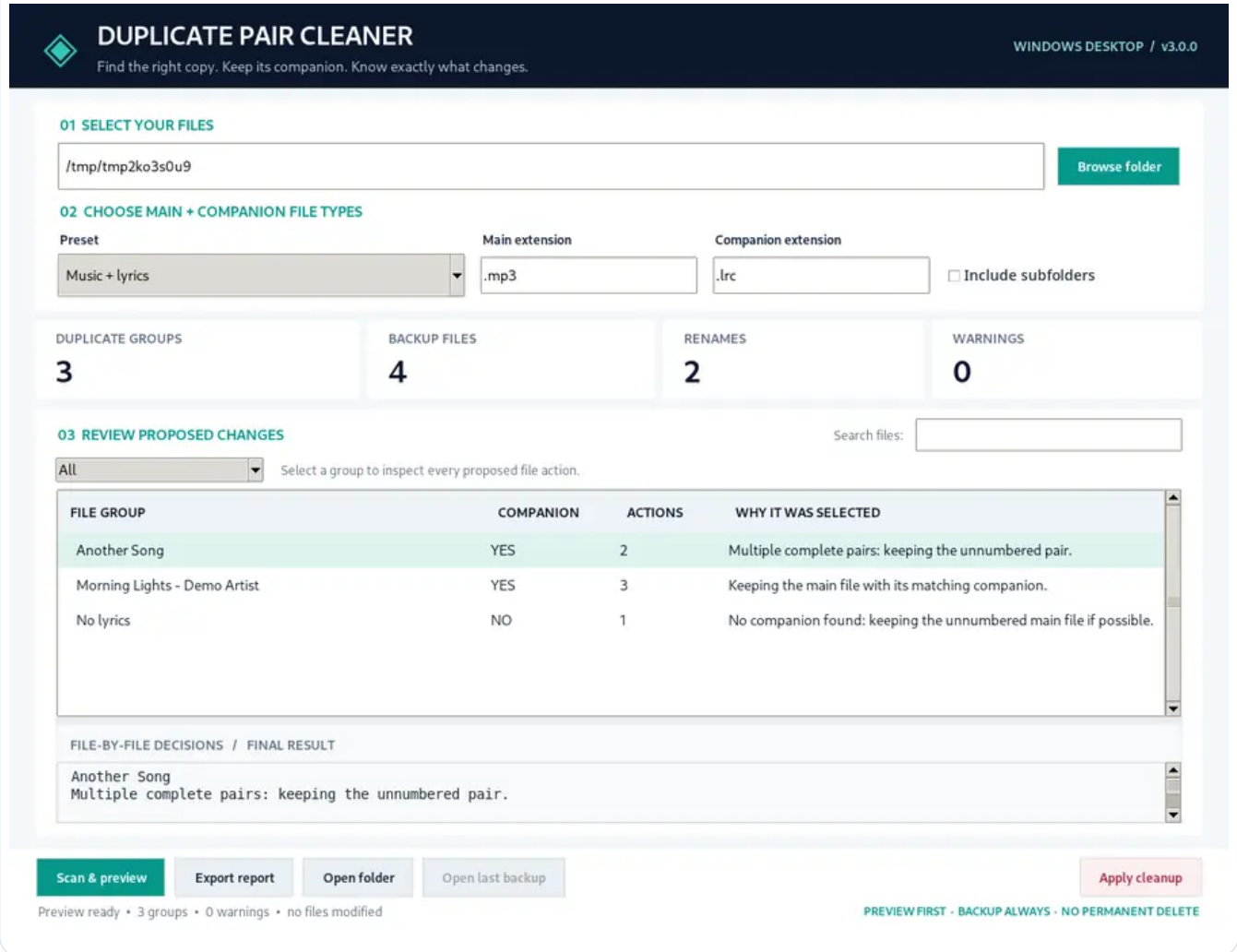
Created by DimitrisLai

WHAT HAS CHANGED

Welcome to the new interface

Duplicate Pair Cleaner is now a graphical Windows application. It keeps the selected file and its optional matching companion, even when that means replacing the unnumbered copy with the one that has lyrics.

THE ACTUAL APPLICATION



Visual walkthrough: the upper section selects the folder and extensions. The summary tiles show groups, backups, renames and warnings. The lower section reveals every decision. The bottom action bar handles Preview, Export and Apply.

QUICK START

Install and launch

NO PYTHON INSTALLATION REQUIRED

The Windows portable ZIP contains a compiled executable and its support files. Extract everything first, then start the EXE.

1. **Download the portable ZIP**

   Open the latest GitHub v3.0.0 Release and download the Windows-Portable ZIP.

2. **Extract all files**

   Right-click the ZIP and choose Extract All. Keep the DuplicatePairCleaner folder intact.

3. **Launch the application**

   Double-click DuplicatePairCleaner.exe inside the extracted DuplicatePairCleaner folder.

4. **Choose your folder**

   Click Browse folder; or paste a full path in the box.

5. **Select file types**

   Use the music, subtitles, photo or custom preset. Subfolders are optional.

6. **Preview, then confirm**

   Click Scan & preview. Apply cleanup is available only after review.

WINDOWS SECURITY NOTE

This is an unsigned open-source build. If Windows warns about an unknown publisher, confirm that the file came from the verified GitHub release and review the source before running it.

CONFIGURE

Select the right file types

The Main extension is what you want to keep: music, video, photo, or recording. The Companion extension is its matching file, such as lyrics, subtitles, XMP metadata or notes.

.mp3	.lrc	Music and synchronized lyrics
.mp4	.srt	Video and subtitles
.flac	.lrc	Lossless music and lyrics
.jpg	.xmp	Photos and metadata
.wav	.txt	Audio recordings and notes

VALIDATION AND RECURSIVE MODE

Choose two different extensions (with or without a leading dot). Subfolder scanning is off by default. If enabled, the same song name in two different subdirectories is never mixed.

What the tool does not analyze

No audio or video quality analysis. No hashes, content fingerprinting, music metadata, or automatic guessing that two differently named tracks sound alike.

UNDERSTAND THE RESULTS

Preview every change

The preview displays changes grouped by base filename. Click any row to inspect decisions. Search for a track, filter by companion availability or export the full plan without modifying files.

```
Song - Demo Artist
[BACKUP]  Song - Demo Artist.mp3
[RENAME]  Song - Demo Artist(1).mp3
      -> Song - Demo Artist.mp3
[RENAME]  Song - Demo Artist(1).lrc
```

KEEP	Existing file is retained unchanged.
BACKUP	Extra file will be moved to a dated backup.
RENAME	Selected file will receive a cleaned-up name.

NO FILE CHANGES DURING PREVIEW

Scan & preview reads filenames and file statistics only. Export report writes a text file wherever you choose; it does not rename or delete any selected media.

SELECTION RULES

Which copy wins?

Rule 1 / Prefer matching companions

Keep a main file whose numbered suffix has a matching companion: e.g. Song(1).mp3 + Song(1).lrc.

Rule 2 / Unnumbered wins when both pairs exist

Song.mp3 + Song.lrc wins over Song(1).mp3 + Song(1).lrc. The numbered pair goes into backup.

Rule 3 / No companion available

Keep the unnumbered main file, if present, otherwise the lowest numbered main file.

Rule 4 / Preserve legitimate names

Only trailing (1) through (999) are considered duplicate suffixes. Descriptive (Live), (Remix), (2026), etc. are not removed.

Rule 5 / Avoid uncertain situations

A lone numbered copy or numbered complete pair is left unchanged. Groups with ambiguous case collisions are skipped, and no unrelated extensions are touched.

THE ORIGINAL EXAMPLE

Before: Song.mp3 + Song(1).mp3 + Song(1).lrc. After: Song.mp3 (the former numbered MP3) + Song.lrc. The former unnumbered MP3 is backed up.

BACKUP WORKFLOW

Apply safely and recover

After preview, Apply cleanup opens a confirmation window showing the selected folder and exact proposed backup/rename totals. Clicking No changes nothing. Clicking Yes starts the operation.

```
C:/Music/
  Song.mp3
  Song.lrc
  _File_Pair_Cleaner_Backup_20261021_123000_123456/
    manifest.json
    duplicates/
      Song.mp3
```

What is inside the backup?

Extra files are moved under duplicates/. The JSON manifest records their original paths and all rename operations. Use Open last backup from the GUI after the cleanup.

How to restore

Close other programs, read manifest.json, check for occupied final names and copy the selected original files back. There is no automatic restore button.

INTERRUPTION SAFETY

The application rechecks file changes and refuses occupied destinations. Best-effort rollback is attempted after failures; abrupt power loss can still require manual recovery.

HELP AND SAFETY

Troubleshooting and privacy

No duplicate groups found

Check selected extensions and the final (1), (2) duplicate-number suffix.

Folder picker or folder unavailable

Choose another accessible folder. Close players, editors or software locking files.

Warnings about ambiguous names

Some groups were intentionally skipped instead of risking an overwrite.

A file changed after scanning

Run Scan & preview again. Apply requires a fresh, safe plan.

An antivirus warns about the EXE

This program is unsigned. Check that it came from the GitHub release and review the public source.

The executable will not start

Extract the complete ZIP and keep all support files alongside DuplicatePairCleaner.exe.

PRIVACY BY DESIGN

This tool runs locally and does not upload file names, media, logs or other personal information. It does not use analytics, advertising or cloud services.

OPEN SOURCE

Project and release information

Duplicate Pair Cleaner 3.0.0 is open-source software by DimitrisLai. The core matching algorithm is preserved from stable version 2.2.0; version 3 adds the desktop interface.

Source and license

MIT License. All Python source, tests, build scripts, workflows and release notes are published on GitHub.

Technical requirements

For the Windows portable EXE, Python is included in the bundle. Source version requires Python 3.10+ with Tkinter.

Development verification

Regression tests cover file-selection priorities, backup and rollback behavior and GUI data model. Windows EXE packaging is performed by GitHub Actions on Windows.

Windows test disclaimer

You should still test Browse, Preview, Apply and Open backup on your own Windows computer before using it on irreplaceable libraries.

OFFICIAL PROJECT

github.com/DimitrisLai/Duplicate-Pair-Cleaner

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